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# Follett Software

Senior Director, Software Development

**\*\*Target Role:\*\*** Senior Director, Software Development **\*\*Lead Record:\*\*** [ `wwwworkremote` Lead #126] (<http://localhost:31000/admin/leads/126>) / [Posting #5624]([http://localhost:31000/api/v0/job\\_postings/5624](http://localhost:31000/api/v0/job_postings/5624))

**\*\*Company Profile:\*\*** Follett Software (Chicago, IL / Remote — K–12 Education Technology, Destiny Library Platform) **\*\*Tone Calibration:\*\*** Understated, zero-fluff, honest level assessment. --- ## 1. Role Scope & Stack Analysis \* **\*\*Scope:\*\*** Executive engineering director leading multiple product lines (Destiny Library Manager, Resource Manager, Accessit Library). Manages Development Managers and Senior Engineers. \* **\*\*Core Technical Mandate:\*\*** Legacy modernization (Java, J2EE, .NET, JBoss, WildFly, SQL Server, jQuery → Azure cloud microservices), back-to-school peak load reliability, Spec-Driven Development, and AI workflow adoption. \* **\*\*Management Burden:\*\*** Direct people management, performance coaching, succession planning, recruiting, and budget ownership across multiple product managers/teams. --- ## 2. Fit & Level Calibration (Skeptical Peer Lens) | Dimension | Target Role Expectation | Mike's Grounded Signal | Fit Status | | :--- | :--- | :--- | :--- | | **\*\*Technical Mandate\*\*** | Modernize legacy Java/J2EE/.NET monoliths to cloud; establish Spec-Driven workflows & telemetry. | Led OneMain Acquisition lane modernization, OpenTelemetry enterprise rollout across 36+ services, and 90-day EMR-Bear legacy audit. |  Strong Match | | **\*\*Operational Peak\*\*** | Ensure 100% uptime during high-stakes back-to-school enrollment peak. | Handled peak loan acquisition load; reduced system-wide MTTR by 60% via real-time tracing. |  Strong Match | | **\*\*Role Track\*\*** | Executive People Director (managing managers, HR reviews, budget tracking). | Principal Software Engineer / Staff Architect (Technical IC leadership; OneMain Associate Director was an IC corporate grade with no direct reports). |  Track Mismatch | | **\*\*Work Environment\*\*** | Heavy synchronous management & cross-departmental administrative meetings. | High-autonomy Principal IC track with async RFC/ADR documentation focus. |  Potential Friction | --- ## 3. Strategic Recommendation \* **\*\*Primary Recommendation:** De-prioritize for IC Target Roles.\*\* If your job search priority is a Principal IC / System Architect role with deep technical ownership and low management administrative overhead, this Senior Director post is a structural mismatch. \* **\*\*Alternative Pitch (If Pursuing as Chief Architect / Principal):\*\*** If Follett is attractive as a Chicago/Remote EdTech target, do not position as a people-manager. Pitch as a **\*\*Principal Software Engineer / Chief Architect\*\*** who will partner with their

Director of Engineering to execute the multi-product legacy modernization (Java/J2EE -> microservices), enforce Spec-Driven Development standards, and safeguard back-to-school reliability.

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